BSBHRM417

Support human resources functions and processes

Assessment 1 of 2

Short answer questions

SWINBURNE OPEN EDUCATION

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Assessment Instructions

Task overview

This assessment task requires you to answer nine (9) short answer questions. Read each question carefully before typing your response in the space provided.

Assessment Information

Submission

You are entitled to three (3) attempts to complete this assessment satisfactorily. Incomplete assessments will not be marked and will count as one of your three attempts.

All questions must be responded to correctly to be assessed as satisfactory for this assessment.

Answers must be typed into the space provided and submitted electronically via the LMS. Hand-written assessments will not be accepted unless previously arranged with your assessor.

Reasonable adjustment

Students may request a reasonable adjustment for assessment tasks.

Reasonable adjustment usually involves varying:

- the processes for conducting the assessment (e.g. allowing additional time)
- the evidence gathering techniques (e.g. oral rather than written questioning, use of a scribe, modifications to equipment)

However, the evidence collected must allow the student to demonstrate all requirements of the unit.

Refer to the Student Handbook or contact your Trainer for further information.

Please consider the environment before printing this assessment.

Question 1

Explain the key purpose of the Fair Work Act 2009.
(Approximate word count: 40 words)

Key purpose of the Fair Work Act 2009
The Fair Work Act 2009 regulates employer-employee relationships, fostering an environment that promotes fairness, flexibility, and workplace peace, providing a balanced framework for cooperative and productive workplace relations by providing a safety net of minimum terms, such as National Employment Standards (NES) frameworks, to enforce fair employment conditions.

Question 2

Outline the **eleven (11)** minimum entitlements of the National Employment Standards. Who do they apply to?

National Employment Standards	
1.	Fair Work Information Statement and Casual Employment Information Statement
2.	Parental leave & entitlements
3.	Public holiday entitlements
4.	Maximum weekly hours
5.	Annual leave entitlements
6.	Community service leave entitlements
7.	Flexible working arrangements
8.	Notice of termination and redundancy pay requirements
9.	Personal/carer's leave, family & domestic violence leave, and compassionate leave entitlements
10.	Casual employment
11.	Long service leave entitlements
Who does the NES apply to? (Approximate word count: 40 words)	
National Employment Standards apply to all national system employees in Australia, including full-time, part-time and casual employees, regardless of industry and/or occupation. Employers must ensure they are meeting these standards at all times, for all employees; otherwise, they may face repercussions in accordance with the Fair Work Act 2009.	

Question 3

Identify and briefly describe the purpose of **three (3)** pieces of discrimination legislation that apply to the human resources area. They can be state or commonwealth legislation.

(Approximate word count: 50 words per description)

Legislation		Brief description
1.	Age Discrimination Act 2004	The Age Discrimination Act 2004 is legislation that protects employees from age discrimination in all aspects of employment, including recruitment, training, promotion, and termination. Employers must adhere to the Age Discrimination Act 2004 when vetting potential employees, to ensure that every employee – regardless of age – has a fair opportunity to secure employment.
2.	Racial Discrimination Act 1975	The Racial Discrimination Act 1975 protects potential employees from discrimination based on race. Employers who decline the employment of a candidate or treat staff differently based on race are in direct violation of the Racial Discrimination Act 1975 and may face serious repercussions as a result.
3.	Sex Discrimination Act 1984	Legislation such as the Sex Discrimination Act 1984 protects applicants and employees from discrimination based on gender, ensuring that the gender of a candidate cannot be used as a contributing factor in the recruitment & selection process, nor can it be used against an employee within the organisation.

Question 4

Identify and briefly describe **three (3)** human resources policies and procedures commonly used in organisations.

(Approximate word count: 20 words per description)

Human Resources Policy and Procedure		Brief description
1.	Anti-discrimination policies	Anti-discrimination policies protect employees from negative treatment based on factors such as sex, age, race, disability, etc.
2.	Non-smoking policy	A non-smoking policy outlines the organisation's smoking policy. It may dictate how often an employee may have a

		cigarette break, where the designated staff smoking area is, and any restrictions on smoking during working hours.
3.	Code of Conduct	A Code of Conduct outlines the minimum requirements of staff while employed at the organisation. The document may include smoking policies, uniform requirements, punctuality reminders, and policies on body art such as tattoos and piercings.

Question 5

Outline **three (3)** key ethical obligations of human resources personnel.
(Approximate word count: 20 words per description)

Ethical obligation		Brief description
1.	Advertising	When creating job listings, HR personnel must be sure to use inclusive, non-discriminatory language and avoid any bias towards or against age, sex, race, etc
2.	Interviewing	HR personnel must ensure that interviews are conducted based on objective criteria, such as skills and experience, to guarantee that all candidates are assessed consistently and fairly.
3.	Security and storage of personal information	It is imperative that HR personnel safeguard employee privacy by correctly maintaining employee personal data. Personal information should be stored securely and protected from access by unauthorised parties.

Question 6

Outline **four (4)** features of a Human Resources Management System (HRMS), including features that can analyse human resources metrics.

(Approximate word count: 50 words total)

HRMS Features

1.	HRMS systems can analyse workforce metrics such as turnover rates, absenteeism, and performance trends to support decision-making.
2.	Metrics such as time and attendance data, including rosters, timesheets, leave and payroll, can be measured and analysed using an HRMS system.
3.	Onboarding materials such as tax forms, superannuation details, induction materials and probation information can be organised and collated in an HRMS.
4.	HRMS systems can also manage application tracking, interview records, letters of offer and job descriptions

Question 7

Outline **three (3)** key responsibilities of the following human resources roles.

(Approximate word count: 50 words total)

	Human Resources Manager	Recruitment Officer	Employee Relations Officer
1.	Develops policies & procedures	Organises and conducts the recruitment of staff	Negotiates terms and conditions of employment
2.	Guides top executives in strategic planning	Participates in the onboarding process	Takes part in activities like wrongful dismissal claims
3.	Supports management with recruitment, interviews & hiring	Connects with employment agencies and industry associations	Manages workplace disputes and ensures compliance with employment laws

Question 8

Identify a human resources network for each of the following areas. In your answer, include the name of the organisation and its key purpose.

(Approximate word count: 30 words per network)

Area		Human resources network
1.	In your local area	The Victorian Chamber of Commerce and Industry runs local networking events and HR training across Melbourne, connecting HR professionals with businesses to share workplace relations knowledge and best practices.
2.	For your state or territory	The Australian HR Institute provides networking events across Australia, including professional development seminars and in-person forums about HR laws & legislation changes for HR professionals.
3.	Australia wide	HR Hackers is an Australia-wide HR community that connects professionals through events, discussions, and shared resources, focusing on modern HR practices, people analytics, and innovative approaches to workplace management.
4.	Internationally	The International Association for Human Resource Information Management (IHRIM) supports HR professionals globally through networking, special interest groups, and HR technology resources.

Question 9

In your own words, define the term ‘workforce sustainability’.

(Approximate word count: 40 words)

Define ‘workforce sustainability’

Workforce sustainability refers to maintaining a healthy, skilled, and adaptable workforce over time by supporting employee wellbeing, development, and retention to meet current and future organisational needs.

Assessment checklist:

Students must have completed all short answer questions within this assessment before submitting. This includes:

1	9 short answer questions to be completed in the spaces provided.	☐

Congratulations you have reached the end of Assessment 1!

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